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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **TikTok officially** established a joint venture that would allow it to keep operating in the U.S., resolving its yearslong fight to address U.S. national-security concerns. **A1**

◆ **Intel swung to a loss** in the fourth quarter and forecast further losses in the first quarter as the company spends heavily to boost production of its latest chips. **B1**

◆ **The relief rally in U.S. stocks** spread to smaller companies, sending the Russell 2000 index to a record, while the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rose 0.5%, 0.9% and 0.6%, respectively. **B10**

◆ **The inflation gauge** tracked by the Fed held steady between September and November, showing that price increases remained mildly elevated as 2025 wound down. **A2**

◆ **Capital One agreed** to buy fintech firm Brex for \$5.15 billion in cash and stock in a deal that would give the credit-card issuer more clout with corporate clients. **B2**

◆ **Trump said he is** “not a huge fan” of a plan one of his senior advisers floated last week to let 401(k) holders tap their accounts for a down payment on a home. **A2**

◆ **Spice and seasoning** maker McCormick posted higher sales for the fourth quarter but expects elevated costs to depress profit for the fiscal year. **B3**

◆ **Autodesk plans to cut** about 1,000 jobs, or roughly 7% of its workforce, as part of a global restructuring as it seeks to strengthen sales and marketing. **B3**

◆ **GE Aerospace reported** higher revenue as orders continued to grow amid rising air travel and defense demand. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Trump sued JPMorgan** Chase and CEO Jamie Dimon for \$5 billion, alleging the bank improperly closed his accounts for political reasons after the 2021 Capitol riot. **A1**

◆ **The Greenland crisis**, though defused through a compromise negotiated by NATO's Rutte, has European leaders worrying about long-term damage. **A1, A6**

◆ **The Trump administration** is searching for Cuban government insiders who can help cut a deal to push out the Communist regime in Havana by the end of the year. **A1**

◆ **A resolution to rein in** Trump's powers to wage war in Venezuela was narrowly defeated in the House, after GOP leaders hustled a lawmaker back from Texas to cast the deciding vote. **A3**

◆ **Democratic Sen. Amy** Klobuchar of Minnesota is poised to enter her state's race for governor following the decision by Gov. Tim Walz not to seek a third term. **A3**

◆ **Vice President JD Vance** on a visit to Minneapolis called for greater cooperation with immigration enforcement and a lowering of the political temperature. **A3**

◆ **A magistrate judge** refused to sign off on a complaint charging former CNN journalist Don Lemon for his involvement in an anti-immigration enforcement protest in Minnesota. **A3**

◆ **Washington is** considering withdrawing all American troops from Syria as the government in Damascus moved to wrest control of the northeastern part of the country from a U.S.-backed, Kurdish-led militia. **A8**

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Jan. 6 Prosecutor Smith: ‘I Will Not Be Intimidated’



CAPITOL CONFRONTATION: Former special counsel Jack Smith said at a House hearing Thursday he expects the Trump administration will seek to prosecute him for investigating the president. Afterward, Trump said he wants to do just that. **A4**

Europe Distrust of Washington Lingers After Greenland Crisis

Allies fear more upheaval despite Trump's U-turn on military force, tariffs

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

DAVOS, Switzerland—The West avoided an open rupture this week. But instead of celebrating, European leaders are bracing for more serious shocks to the trans-Atlantic relationship in coming months. “We are not yet out of the woods,” President Edgars Rinkēvičs of Latvia said

Thursday, after President Trump U-turned on threats of military action and punitive tariffs to seize Greenland from Denmark. “Are we in an irreversible rift? No. But there is a clear and present danger. If we want to preserve the alliance, both sides need to be very, very careful.”

The crisis over Greenland, though defused through a compromise negotiated by North Atlantic Treaty Organization Secretary-General Mark Rutte, has many European leaders worrying about long-term damage.

“We are in a much better

place today than we were at the beginning of this week,” Foreign Minister Espen Barth Eide of Norway said. “But of course, the very fact that we are relieved that a NATO country is not going to attack another NATO country tells us that we are somewhere where we never thought we would be. And that, in itself, will linger.”

Trump's approach to Greenland has also prompted leaders in Europe and Canada to focus more on reducing their countries' economic, technological and military dependence on the U.S., the kind of derisking previously reserved

for China and Russia. Some European officials have started seriously worrying about the exposure of their economies to U.S. software, payment systems and communications platforms that could be switched off or disrupted in case of an escalating conflict.

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- ◆ **James Mackintosh: What TACO means for markets...B1**

U.S. Seeks New Regime In Cuba by End of Year

Emboldened by the U.S. ouster of President Nicolás Maduro of Venezuela, the Trump administration is searching for Cuban government insiders who can help cut a deal to push out the

By José de Córdoba in Mexico City, Vera Bergengruen in Washington and Deborah Acosta in Miami

Communist regime by the end of the year, people familiar with the matter said.

The Trump administration has assessed that Cuba's economy is close to collapse and that the government has never been this fragile after losing a vital benefactor in

Maduro, these people said. Officials don't have a concrete plan to end the Communist government that has held power on the Caribbean island for almost seven decades, but they see Maduro's capture and subsequent concessions from his allies left behind as a blueprint and a warning for Cuba, senior U.S. officials said.

“I strongly suggest they make a deal. BEFORE IT IS TOO LATE,” President Trump stated in a Jan. 11 social-media post in which he said “NO MORE OIL OR MONEY” would be going to Cuba.

In meetings with Cuban exiles and civic groups in Miami

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A Frenchman in Sunglasses Captivates the Global Elite

* * *

Emmanuel Macron's shades in Davos had many wondering if he was sending a message

By MATTHEW DALTON

When French President Emmanuel Macron strode to the stage in Davos wearing a pair of reflective aviator sunglasses, many thought he was sending a message: It was time for someone in Europe to stand up to President Trump.

Was Macron evoking Tom Cruise's cocky fighter pilot Maverick in “Top Gun,” signaling that he wouldn't back down against Trump's demands for control of Greenland? Others thought he might be throwing shade by wearing aviator-style sunglasses favored by former President Biden, the object of Trump's constant derision.

Some saw bigger stakes: “Can Macron's sunglasses save the West?” read a headline in

the Telegraph, the conservative British newspaper.

Macron in fact intended none of those things, French officials said. The sunglasses were meant to hide a burst blood vessel in his eye.

Nevertheless, photographs of Macron wearing the shades made the front pages of newspapers around the world. The blue-tinted lenses seemed to resonate perfectly with the cobalt blue background of the Davos stage, creating a striking effect. Shares of the Italian company that owns the sunglasses brand jumped on the Milan stock exchange.

Memos proliferated across the internet, fueled by generative AI. Macron was shown as a fighter pilot, flashing the

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INSIDE



MANSION

Once a remote outpost, Big Sky is now a destination for wealthy ski-home buyers. **M1**

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Natural-gas prices soar and grid worries rise as U.S. braces for arctic blast. **B1**

TikTok Wraps Up Deal to Stay in U.S.

By AMRITH RAMKUMAR

TikTok officially established a joint venture that would allow it to keep operating in the U.S., the company said Thursday, resolving a yearslong fight to address Washington's national-security concerns.

Under the terms of the deal negotiated by the Trump administration, the popular video-sharing app will be operated by a new U.S. entity controlled by investors seen as friendly to the U.S.

Its data-management and algorithm-training on American users will be overseen by Oracle, the cloud-computing company that has safeguarded its U.S. data for years and has close ties to the Trump ad-

ministration.

The deal was negotiated to comply with a law passed in 2024. President Trump delayed the implementation of the law a year ago after starting his second term to keep TikTok operating in the U.S. He signed a series of executive orders to extend the deadline for completing a deal until it was met Thursday.

“I am so happy to have helped in saving TikTok!” Trump said in a social-media post Thursday night. He thanked Chinese leader Xi Jinping “for working with us and, ultimately, approving the Deal. He could have gone the other way, but didn't, and is appreciated for his decision.”

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Insurers’ Big Profits Draw Regulators’ Ire

By JEAN EAGLESHAM

Insurance companies that cover homes and cars are reaping the rewards of the inflation-busting price increases that have squeezed household budgets nationwide.

But the stark contrast between near-record profits and sharp rate hikes has put the industry in the regulatory firing line. Insurers are starting to feel the heat from the political wrangle over affordability.

New York Gov. Kathy Hochul, a Democrat, became this month the latest state official to advocate profits caps on insurers, to tackle escalating home- and “crushingly expensive” auto-insurance rates.

Her plan would require home insurers with “outsized profit margins” to lower or justify their rates, and review the profits threshold at which auto insurers are required to

refund customers.

Also this month, lawmakers in states including Oklahoma proposed profit caps targeting insurance.

“The near-record profits are fueling tremendous anger...among people in every state,” said Amy Bach, executive director of consumer group United Policyholders.

Travelers Cos., an insurer seen as a bellwether for the industry, reported on Wednesday net income last year jumped 26% to \$6.3 billion, up from \$5 billion in 2024. Chief Executive Alan Schnitzer said the results reflected exceptional performance across the business.

This quarter's round of insurer earnings will likely intensify the pressure for politicians to act. Companies are set to report even better results than 2024, when they recovered from

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Cancer’s New Milestone

Colorectal cancer has become the leading cause of cancer death in the U.S. among people under 50. **A2**

Cancer deaths for ages 20–49, by cause, 2023

Colon and rectum	3,905
Breast	3,809
Brain and ONS*	2,086
Lung and bronchus	1,774
Pancreas	1,051
Leukemia	684
Uterine cervix	396

*Other nervous system
Source: American Cancer Society